

Merriam-Webster's Vocabulary Builder • Unit 1 复习

8 大词根 × 每根 4 词（32 词）+ 神话与历史 8 词 = 共 40 词 | 词根整理 + 配套练习

2026 年 8 月 27 日 | 内容忠实原书 2nd Ed. | 含词根速查、详解、自测与答案

一、词根速查总表

词根	含义	代表词（4 词一组）
BENE	well 好	benediction • benefactor • beneficiary • benevolence
AM	love 爱	amicable • enamored • amorous • paramour
BELL	war 战争	antebellum • bellicose • belligerence • rebellion
PAC	peace / agree 和平、同意	pacify • pacifist • pact • pace
CRIM	crime / fault / accusation 罪、过错、指控	criminology • decriminalize • incriminate • recrimination
PROB	prove / honesty 证明、诚实	approbation • probate • probity • reprobate
GRAV	heavy / serious 重、严重	grave • gravitas • gravitate • aggravate
LEV	light / raise 轻、举起	alleviate • elevation • cantilever • levity

二、词根详解（每根 4 词）

① BENE = well 「好」

词源：拉丁语 **bene** 「好」。西班牙语 **bueno**、法语 **bon**、意大利语 **bene** 同源——"好！/太好了！"

单词	中文含义	英文释义 + 要点
benediction n.	祝福祷告、赐福	a prayer asking God's blessing（礼拜结尾的祝福）；bene + dictio「说」→"说好话"
benefactor n.	捐助者、恩人	one who helps another, esp. by giving money；bene + facere「做」→"做好事的人"
beneficiary n.	受益人	one who receives benefit / money, esp. after sb dies；人寿保险常见搭配
benevolence n.	仁慈、善心、慷慨	kindness, generosity；bene + volo「愿」→"愿人好"；形容词 benevolent

⚠ 区分方向

benefactor（给的人）↔ **beneficiary**（收的人），别搞反：donor 相当于 benefactor。

2 AM = love 「爱」

词源：拉丁语 **amare** 「爱」。罗马爱神有两个名字：Cupid 与 **Amor**；西班牙语 **amigo** 「朋友」同源

单词	中文含义	英文释义 + 要点
amicable adj.	友好的、和平的	friendly, peaceful——常形容两国/两组关系：amicable settlement（和平解决）
enamored adj.	着迷的、迷恋的	charmed, fascinated；be enamored of / with 两种介词都常用
amorous adj.	多情的、情爱的	having strong feelings of love——常带"肉欲/亲密"色彩
paramour n.	情人（秘密的、不合礼法的）	a lover, often secret；法语 par amour 「出于爱情」→ 婚外情人

⚠ 程度差异

amicable（客气的友好，用于关系/协议）≠ **amorous**（情欲之爱）≠ **enamored**（如痴如醉的迷恋）。

3 BELL = war 「战争」

词源：拉丁语 **bellum** 「战争」。罗马的战争女神叫 **Bellona**（战神马尔斯之妻），名字即由此来

单词	中文含义	英文释义 + 要点
antebellum adj.	战前的（尤指美国内战前）	existing before a war；ante- 「前」+ bellum；指美国南方的旧时光
bellicose adj.	好战的、好斗的、寻衅的	warlike, aggressive——形容国家及其领导人（如威廉二世、墨索里尼）
belligerence n.	好战性、挑衅、敌意	aggressiveness, combativeness；belligerent 还可做名词「交战国」
rebellion n.	叛乱、反抗	open defiance of authority（常武装）；rebel 动词/名词；叛乱升级=革命

⚠ 辨析

bellicose 多形容"国家/领袖的好战态度"；**belligerence** 可小到个人、大到全球；**rebellion** 是对权威的反抗（不一定成功），**revolution** 是推翻政权的革命。

4 PAC = peace / agree 「和平、同意」

词源：拉丁语 **pax, pacis** 「和平；协议」。太平洋 Pacific Ocean 即"太平之洋"，由麦哲伦命名（他显然没见过台风）

单词	中文含义	英文释义 + 要点
pacify v.	平息、安抚；武装镇压	to soothe anger / subdue by force；pacifier 安抚奶嘴
pacifist n.	和平主义者、反战者	one opposed to war / refuses to fight；甘地、马丁·路德·金是代表
pact n.	协定、条约、盟约	a formal agreement between nations or people；arms pact 军备协定
pace prep.	与……相反；恕我直言（学术用语）	contrary to the opinion of；拉丁语，"peace to them"——非要说却不想吵架

⚠ pace 陷阱

与"步速"pace 拼写相同，但此处读 /ˈpɑːtʃeɪ/（拉丁音）且常印成斜体，只出现在书面评论中。

5 CRIM = crime / fault / accusation 「罪、过错、指控」

词源：拉丁语 **crimen** 「罪行；指控」。crime 比 tort（民事侵权）更严重——犯罪由官府起诉，侵权须当事人自诉

单词	中文含义	英文释义 + 要点
criminology n.	犯罪学	study of crime, criminals, law enforcement, punishment
decriminalize v.	使非刑事化	remove / reduce criminal status; ≠legalize (合法化)，可能仍罚小款
incriminate v.	牵连、归罪	show evidence of involvement in a crime; incriminating evidence 罪证
recrimination n.	反控、互相指责	an accusation in answer to an accusation; re- 回应 + criminate

⚠ 辨析

decriminalize ≠ legalize：非刑事化可能仍留小额罚款（如交通罚单）；合法化则完全合法。另 **incriminate** 不一定指真犯罪，可表“有迹象表明是某病因”。

6 PROB = prove / honesty 「证明、诚实」

词源：拉丁语 **probare** 「证明、检验」及 **probus** 「正直」。probe（探测器）就是在“找证据”；probable 原义“尚可证明的”

单词	中文含义	英文释义 + 要点
approbation n.	认可、嘉许、正式批准	formal approval; praise——比 approval 更强、更正式
probate n.	遗嘱检验	court process to prove a will valid & administer the estate
probity n.	正直、诚实	absolute honesty and uprightness; 官方/银行家应具备的品质
reprobate n.	恶棍、道德败坏者	a person of thoroughly bad character; 对应动词 reprove 「责备」；莎翁笔下的福斯塔夫

⚠ 注意

approbation（认可）与 **reprobate**（恶棍）都以 pro 为核心：approve 「赞成」↔ reprove 「谴责」，加 -ate/-ation 后词义南辕北辙。

7 GRAV = heavy / serious 「重、严重」

词源：拉丁语 **gravis** 「重、沉、严重」。gravity 万有引力让物体"变重"；grave（坟墓）一词其实与它无关，只是谐音

单词	中文含义	英文释义 + 要点
grave adj.	严重的；庄重的	requiring serious concern; a grave situation 形势严峻；= 名词"坟墓"拼写同但源异
gravitas n.	庄重、威严、尊严	great dignified seriousness——拉丁直借词；长者/掌权者的气质
gravitate v.	被吸引、自然倾向	be drawn toward（如被引力牵引）；gravitate toward 常考搭配
aggravate v.	加重、恶化；使恼火	make worse / annoy; ag- 加强——把伤"加重"，今天更多用于"惹恼"

⚠ aggrivate 双义

本义"使更严重"，口语多用"惹恼"义。注意与 aggravate（加重）相对的减轻动词是 **alleviate**。

8 LEV = light / raise 「轻、举起」

词源：拉丁语 **levis** 「轻」、**levare** 「举起、减轻」。lever（杠杆）用来撬起东西；levitation 是魔术师让人"飘起来"

单词	中文含义	英文释义 + 要点
alleviate v.	减轻、缓解	to lighten / relieve (esp. pain or suffering); 只缓不治
elevation n.	高度、海拔；提升、晋升	height / the act of raising; elevated to president 晋升
cantilever n.	悬臂（梁）	a beam projecting from a wall to support sth above; 赖特"流水别墅"
levity n.	轻浮、缺乏严肃	lack of appropriate seriousness; 反义词 gravitas——"一轻一重"

⚠ 成对记忆

levity（轻浮）↔ gravitas（庄重）是绝妙反义对；alleviate（减轻）↔ aggravate（加重）也是。

三、神话与历史词回顾（Unit 1 特殊章节）

8 个词按来源分三类：**人名系** cicerone (Cicero) · hector (Hector) · nestor (Nestor) · stentorian (Stentor)；**地名系** spartan (Sparta) · sybaritic (Sybaris)；**哲学系** hedonism (hēdonē 快乐) · stoic (Stoics 学派)。详细故事见同日《神话与历史词汇》文档。

单词	今日含义	来源
cicerone n.	讲解员、文化导游	Cicero 西塞罗（雄辩演说家）
hector v.	威吓、欺凌	Hector 赫克托耳（伦敦地痞团伙名）
hedonism n.	享乐主义	希腊语 hēdonē 「快乐」
nestor n.	前辈、元老	Nestor 涅斯托尔（特洛伊最年长老将）
spartan adj.	简朴清苦的、自律的	Sparta 斯巴达（全民皆兵之城邦）
stentorian adj.	（嗓音）洪亮浑厚的	Stentor 斯滕托尔（声如铜锣的传令官）
stoic adj./n.	坚忍克己的；坚忍的人	Stoics 斯多葛学派

单词	今日含义	来源
sybaritic adj.	骄奢淫逸的	Sybaris 锡巴里斯（奢靡古城）

四、配套练习

练习一 · 词根配对 把左列词根与右列含义连线

1. BENE	a. prove / honesty 证明、诚实
2. AM	b. war 战争
3. BELL	c. well 好
4. PAC	d. light / raise 轻、举起
5. CRIM	e. peace 和平、同意
6. PROB	f. heavy / serious 重、严重
7. GRAV	g. love 爱
8. LEV	h. crime / accusation 罪、指控

练习二 A · 释义配对 (BENE / AM) 左列释义 → 右列单词

1. a prayer that asks God's blessing	a. beneficiary
2. one who helps another by giving money	b. amorous
3. one who receives money / property after sb dies	c. benefactor
4. kindness, generosity	d. enamored
5. friendly, peaceful (of relations)	e. benevolence
6. charmed or fascinated	f. paramour
7. having strong feelings of love	g. benediction
8. a lover, often secret	h. amicable

练习二 B · 释义配对 (BELL / PAC)

1. existing before a war	a. rebellion
2. warlike, aggressive	b. pace
3. aggressiveness, combativeness	c. antebellum
4. open defiance of authority	d. pacify
5. to soothe anger or subdue	e. bellicose
6. a person opposed to war	f. pact
7. a formal agreement between nations	g. belligerence
8. contrary to the opinion of	h. pacifist

练习二 C · 释义配对 (CRIM / PROB)

1. the study of crime and law enforcement	a. probate
2. to remove the criminal status of	b. incriminate
3. to show evidence of involvement in a crime	c. criminology
4. an accusation in answer to an accusation	d. reprobate
5. formal approval; praise	e. recrimination
6. the court process of validating a will	f. approbation
7. absolute honesty and uprightness	g. decriminalize
8. a person of thoroughly bad character	h. probity

练习二 D · 释义配对 (GRAV / LEV)

1. serious; solemn (of a situation / manner)	a. elevation
2. great dignified seriousness	b. levity
3. to be drawn toward something	c. aggravate
4. to make worse; to annoy	d. grave
5. to lighten or relieve (pain)	e. gravitate
6. height; the act of raising; promotion	f. alleviate
7. a beam projecting from a wall	g. cantilever
8. lack of appropriate seriousness	h. gravitas

练习三 · 反义配对 选与左列意义相反/相对的正确选项

1. benevolence (仁慈)	a. sybaritic
2. amicable (友好的)	b. stoicism
3. bellicose (好战的)	c. gravitas
4. aggravate (加重)	d. hostile
5. levity (轻浮)	e. malice (恶意)
6. spartan (清苦)	f. alleviate
7. hedonism (享乐主义)	g. peaceful
8. incriminate (归罪)	h. agitate (激怒)
	i. exculpate (开脱罪责)

练习四 A · 语境填空 (词根词 ①) 用词库中单词的正确形式填空

词库: benediction • benefactor • beneficiary • benevolence • amicable • enamored • amorous • paramour • antebellum • bellicose • belligerence • rebellion • pacify • pacifist • pact • pace

- The church service ended with a solemn ____.
- An anonymous ____ donated \$2 million to the city library.
- She was named the sole ____ of her father's life insurance.
- Thanks to the ____ of a kind neighbor, the family got through the winter.
- The two countries finally reached an ____ settlement after months of talks.
- He was completely ____ of the little coastal town and never wanted to leave.
- The tabloid exposed the senator's ____ affair with an aide.
- The duchess arrived at the ball with her ____, scandalizing the court.
- The ____ mansion on the hill has been preserved exactly as it was in 1850.
- The general's ____ speech alarmed all the neighboring states.
- Her unexpected ____ surprised everyone at the normally friendly meeting.
- The students' ____ forced the principal to cancel the school trip.
- A warm bath usually ____ a cranky baby.
- Gandhi, a lifelong ____, won independence without violence.
- The two nations signed a trade ____ to lower tariffs.
- ____ some critics, the movie was a masterpiece.

练习四 B · 语境填空 (词根词 ②)

词库: criminology • decriminalize • incriminate • recrimination • approbation • probate • probity • reprobate • grave • gravitas • gravitate • aggravate • alleviate • elevation • cantilever • levity

1. Her degree in ____ led her to a career as a probation officer.
2. Many states have voted to ____ possession of small amounts of marijuana.
3. The footprints in the snow ____ the night guard.
4. The bitter divorce was followed by years of mutual ____.
5. The crowd's ____ was music to the young performer's ears.
6. The will had to go through ____ before the estate could be divided.
7. The judge was admired for her absolute ____.
8. In the novel, the ____ squandered his entire inheritance in a year.
9. The doctor's face grew ____ as she read the test results.
10. The CEO addressed the staff with the ____ of a head of state.
11. Young voters ____ toward candidates who speak their language.
12. Going back to running will only ____ the knee injury.
13. Cold compresses ____ the swelling, but only rest could cure it.
14. The ____ of the peak is 4,200 meters above sea level.
15. The balcony is supported by a steel ____.
16. His ____ at the funeral deeply shocked the mourners.

练习四 C · 语境填空（神话与历史词）

词库: cicerone · hector · hedonism · nestor · spartan · stentorian · stoic · sybaritic

1. A knowledgeable ____ guided us through the Acropolis and explained every ruin.
2. The big kids used to ____ the younger ones in the schoolyard.
3. After the promotion he embraced a life of ____, spending freely on travel and fine dining.
4. As a ____ of the profession, she was consulted on every major decision.
5. They rented a ____ hotel room with nothing but a bed and a desk.
6. The general's ____ command could be heard across the entire field.
7. He remained ____ through the whole ordeal, never once showing emotion.
8. The resort advertised a ____ spa package for its wealthiest guests.

练习五 · 神话词来源配对 单词 → 名字/地名/词源

1. cicerone	a. Stentor (斯滕托尔)
2. hector	b. Stoics (斯多葛学派)
3. nestor	c. Nestor (涅斯托尔)
4. stentorian	d. hēdonē (希腊语"快乐")
5. spartan	e. Sybaris (锡巴里斯古城)
6. sybaritic	f. Cicero (西塞罗)
7. stoic	g. Hector (赫克托耳)
8. hedonism	h. Sparta (斯巴达城邦)

五、答案

练习一 1-c | 2-g | 3-b | 4-e | 5-h | 6-a | 7-f | 8-d

练习二 A 1-g | 2-c | 3-a | 4-e | 5-h | 6-d | 7-b | 8-f

练习二 B 1-c | 2-e | 3-g | 4-a | 5-d | 6-h | 7-f | 8-b

练习二 C 1-c | 2-g | 3-b | 4-e | 5-f | 6-a | 7-h | 8-d

练习二 D 1-d | 2-h | 3-e | 4-c | 5-f | 6-a | 7-g | 8-b

练习三 1-e | 2-d | 3-g | 4-f | 5-c | 6-a | 7-b | 8-i

练习四 A 1 benediction | 2 benefactor | 3 beneficiary | 4 benevolence | 5 amicable | 6 enamored | 7 amorous
| 8 paramour | 9 antebellum | 10 bellicose | 11 belligerence | 12 rebellion | 13 pacifies | 14 pacifist | 15 pact |
16 Pace

练习四 B 1 criminology | 2 decriminalize | 3 incriminate | 4 recriminations | 5 approbation | 6 probate | 7
probité | 8 reprobate | 9 grave | 10 gravitas | 11 gravitate | 12 aggravate | 13 alleviated | 14 elevation | 15
cantilever | 16 levity

练习四 C 1 cicerone | 2 hector | 3 hedonism | 4 nestor | 5 spartan | 6 stentorian | 7 stoic | 8 sybaritic

练习五 1-f | 2-g | 3-c | 4-a | 5-h | 6-e | 7-b | 8-d